

Sean Olmstead

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About

Multimedia artist working in video and sound, often incorporating sculptural and installation elements, to explore perceptions of time and space, recursive systems, emergent properties, resonance, and the body's relation to these things. I often work with analog media—video cameras, synthesizers, transducers, feedback loops—as their physicality and immediacy are ideal for activating spaces and creating systems which pulse with electricity in a dynamic and ever changing way, allowing for the sense that they are acting upon the viewer, and the viewer is acting upon them. My work also extends into the digital realm with video, sound works, and bespoke computer programs.

Education

University of California Davis — MFA, MMS Art Studio, 2026
San Francisco State University — BA, Studio Art, 2022

Exhibitions / Performances

July, 2026, Crocker Art Museum, Sacramento, Ca
Sound installation.

June, 2026, Jan and Maria Manetti Shrem Museum, Davis, Ca
Group show: *Graduate MFA Exhibition*.

October, 2025, Swim Gallery, San Francisco, Ca
Group show: *Coagula*.

August, 2025, 5 Olive, San Francisco, Ca
Group show: *Solve*.

June, 2025, 120710, Berkeley, Ca
Group show: *Zephyr*.

May, 2025, Manetti Shrem Museum, Davis, Ca
Performance: *Embodied Writing*, (collaboration with Erika Tsimbrovsky).

September, 2023 - Children's Fairyland, Oakland, CA
Performance: *Through the Looking Glass*.

September, 2023 - Bottom of the Hill, San Francisco, Ca
Performance

May, 2023 - Berkeley Art Center, Berkeley, Ca
Performance.

May, 2023 - Bass & Reiner Gallery, San Francisco, Ca
Group show: *Pyramid Scheme*.

October, 2022 - Petepalooza, Oakland, Ca

Performance.

October, 2022 - Milk Bar, San Francisco, Ca

Performance.

October, 2022 - Royal Oakie 10th Anniversary Festival, Balboa Theater, SF, Ca

Performance.

September, 2022 - Ivy Room, San Francisco, Ca

Performance.

February, 2022 - Rickshaw Stop, San Francisco, Ca

Performance.

October, 2021 - Sweetwater, Mill Valley, Ca

Performance.

Awards

UC Davis Letters & Science Prize for Excellence, 2026

Robert Arneson Award, UC Davis, 2026

Mary Lou Osborn Award, UC Davis, 2025

Studio Work

Producer, Already Still Again, San Francisco/ Crockett/ Davis, 2014-present

Running a personal video and music production studio, featuring analog video processing, video synthesis, video mixing, analog 8 track 1/4" tape recording, DAW recording, analog outboard gear, and a wide selection of analog synthesizers.

Misc. Work History

University of California, Davis, 2024-present

Associate instructor, teaching assistant.

Lone Palm, San Francisco, 2014-2024

Lead bartender, assistant manager, various maintenance duties, responsible for providing hospitality and setting the mood and ambience for renowned and popular Mission District bar.

Exploratorium, San Francisco, 2022-2023

Volunteer position, doing digital video editing and production work.

Mekanism, San Francisco, 2014-2018

Production assistant, responsible for assisting with art direction for filmed commercials, production studio maintenance, event production.